construction of dams and canals or for poverty alleviation programmes. Since 2006, India has also contributed financing for projects in other parts of the world. India's direct lending through the World Bank stands at $10.5 billion.[29]

India's membership of the International Monetary Fund (IMF) also dates back to its inception. India has drawn on IMF funds on three occasions, once in the 1980s and twice in the 1990s to address balance of payments problems.[30] India has drawn more on technical assistance from IMF than seeking actual financial assistance. This has included training of Indian officials in monetary policy and tax administration, assistance in foreign exchange market reform as well as in tax and customs administration. Mirroring its stand in the United Nations, India has also sought reform of the IMF quota system so that developing countries – like India – have a greater voice in the IMF.

More recently, India has supported two new financial institutional arrangements – the New Development Bank (also referred to as the BRICS Bank) and the Asian Infrastructure Investment Bank (AIIB). India is a founding member of both institutions. The BRICS Bank was announced in 2013 as a bank that would provide investment for infrastructure development in BRICS and other developing countries. The bank is to be headquartered in Shanghai with an Indian, K.V. Kamath, as the first chief executive.[31] India has also shown interest in the concept of an Asian Infrastructure Investment Bank with around fifty-seven or so founding members including Turkey, Australia, Austria, Israel, Portugal, France, Germany, South Korea and the United Kingdom. For India, inclusion in global financial bodies is a way to demonstrate India's place under the sun in addition to securing economic benefits.[32]

Although deeply involved in international financial institutions (IFIs), Indians are wary of the potential for political and strategic factors influencing their decisions. For example, the Asian Development Bank